

MORPH — Features to Set Us Apart

Gameplay-enhancement catalog from a multi-agent design chatroom (propose → debate → consensus → community-grounded enrichment). Ideas only — no budget/dev/legal. Scores = fun / streamability / retention / feasibility / exploit-resistance.

The signature moves (our differentiators)

- The real data flips the whole thesis: MORPH doesn't have a novelty deficit, it has a TABLE-STAKES deficit. Meccha Chameleon sold ~10M copies at a flat \$5.99 with ZERO MTX and 89% positive — the loudest complaints are all plumbing, not missing mechanics. Front-load the plumbing.
- Friend/party join is the single most-cited real pain ('nearly impossible', 'spent more time joining than playing'). It is P0-existential and the v1 catalog skipped it entirely. Nothing ships before this.
- 'Art defeated by tech': lighting/reflections make hidere 'look nothing like the surroundings' and the eyedropper 'pulls a different shade than what's on screen.' Morph is NOT yet the dominant skill — the renderer is. Core-loop fairness must ship before any novelty stacks on top.
- SILHOUETTE FOLD is the ONE v1 bet that survives scrutiny across all lenses — the credible reason to leave a 10M-copy incumbent. Over-invest in it and make it lighting-robust. It is also the biggest solo-dev technical risk, so fund it by cutting roulette/traitor/emote-as-flagship.
- TELL SKINS is the strongest economy idea and should govern the ENTIRE catalog, not be one item: every cosmetic must be provably non-P2W, auditable in a single streamer screenshot.
- The \$MORPH coin is a solution to a demand nobody has proven. UNVERIFIED appetite + 98.6% pump.fun rug rate + a documented crypto-averse clip audience = net liability at launch. Defer it; validate with honest USD cosmetics first.
- NERVE ENGINE's 'stare = payout' is a bot-farmable faucet (two accounts stare-farm in a private lobby) and inverts the core loop (rewards being spotted). Keep the tension, kill the payout — decouple money from gameplay signals forever.
- The expanded post-round 'answer check' / results screen is beloved AND is the clip-factory GTM engine — treat it as a flagship retention system, not UI polish.

Flagship must-builds

- **Silhouette Fold (Shape Morph)** [5/5/5/2/4 · GAP] — Spend a limited charge to collapse your blob's SILHOUETTE into a nearby prop's outline, not just its texture — become the furniture.
 - Consolidation of Silhouette Break + Fold + Shape-of-the-Season. Aim at a small/medium prop within 4m, hold 1.2s to fold: your outer mesh approximates that prop's outline and snaps texture to match. While folded you are near-undetectable but movement-LOCKED, hold up to 20s, 2 charges/round (regen 1 per 3min, cap 2). Fold quality degrades with volume mismatch (a huge prop = loose fold, a tell). Fold snaps to a validated surface anchor BESIDE geometry (never inside — kills no-clip). Unfold takes 1s with an audible pop that auto-flags the highlight system. Morph stability (Heat Bloom) still drains while folded, forcing eventual

unfold. Returns NO Pulse ping for a few seconds. The FUNCTIONAL ability is a free universal progression unlock; the shape LIBRARY (vase vs box vs gargoyle, identical hitboxes, context-gated) is the paid seasonal cosmetic layer.

- **Nerve Engine (Held Breath + Heat Bloom unified)** [5/5/5/3/4 · GAP] — A seeker's stare simultaneously ramps your score multiplier AND drains your morph stability — the stare that pays you is the stare that melts your disguise.
 - THE keystone merge (Held Breath/Nerve Ladder/Stare-Down + Heat Bloom, endorsed by every persona). While a seeker's active moving cone holds a >75%-matched morphed hider: a private multiplier ramps $x1 \rightarrow x2 \rightarrow x3 \rightarrow x5$ at 3/6/10/15s AND morph stability drains at DOUBLE rate. Points bank per second; any movement >0.3-0.5m or texture change resets the multiplier to $x1$ (banked points are safe) and starts a 2s exhale. At low stability (~20%) a hider-only shimmer warning fires: hold and pray, or risk the 1.2s vulnerable re-lock (full reset on same/good surface, partial on a hasty poor match). Multiplier freezes 4s of grace when the cone leaves. Rendered AS the nameplate turning into a rising NERVE bar (Nameplate Nerve presentation) with a heartbeat SFX; piped to spectator/stream overlay, never to the seeker. 'HELD/Stared Down' banner auto-clips. Anti-farm: seeker must be non-party + actively hunting, per-round Nerve cap, texture-match gate.
- **Whistle Roulette (choose your tell)** [5/5/4/4/4 · GAP] — The forced ~45s whistle becomes a bluff economy: emit True for a nerve bonus, Throw a decoy, or Mute at a cost — but you can never go fully silent.
 - Definitive consolidation of all whistle proposals (Tell / Whistle Roulette / Whistle Cipher / Silence Auction mechanics). Holding still fills a Silence-credit meter that gates spends. 5s before each forced whistle a radial prompt offers: TRUE (emits from real position, +honest-nerve points scaled by nearest-seeker proximity — a point-blank taunt is max risk/reward), or THROW (decoy sound from an LOS-validated point up to 10-20m away, costs the full meter, has a traceable 3s wind-up hiss audible within 8m, hard cooldown, ~2/round). A MUTE option is CUT per anti-exploit consensus — silent camping stays impossible; ignoring the prompt defaults to TRUE. Serial whistlers get progressively pinned by a seeker audio-triangulation passive that sharpens per whistle. Whistle SOUND, throw VFX are cosmetic SKUs (kazoo, opera, streamer voice packs) — timing/volume fixed, never P2W. The Mimic reuses THROW aimed AT the ally as its snitch tool (no bespoke mechanic).
- **Pulse Ping (readable seeker scan)** [4/4/4/4/5 · GAP] — Seekers get a telegraphed sonar pulse that flags morph MISMATCH — but well-blended hidere are invisible to it and spam self-punishes.
 - Press to emit a 12m LOS-gated ring over ~1.5s with a loud charge-up SFX + visible shockwave (giving hidere ~1s to freeze/reblend). Any hider inside whose texture-match is below ~70% gets a 2s highlight; perfectly-blended and Folded hidere return nothing. Cooldown 45s, and each pulse revealing nobody adds +15s to the next cooldown (anti-spam). Freshly-splattered or mid-re-lock hidere ping BRIGHTER; Folded hidere ping not at all — hard-wiring the Fold/Pulse/Warning-Shot counterplay triangle. Never sees through walls. Pulse VFX/SFX are seeker cosmetic sinks.
- **The Mimic (Traitor Hider)** [5/5/4/3/3 · GAP] — One of the two hidere is secretly the Mimic, scored ONLY by causing their partner's tag — the intimate 2-person knife-in-the-back.

- Flagship betrayal role (consolidates Mimic/Impostor Blob/Traitor Chameleon). Spawn rate LOWERED to ~12-15% so most rounds are honestly cooperative and paranoia is earned by rarity. The Mimic sees the partner's faint position pulse; wins only if the OTHER hider is tagged before the timer AND they survive. Sabotage reuses existing systems: the Whistle Roulette THROW aimed AT the ally (ambiguous — taunt or snitch?), plus a gaze-bait beacon. HARD RULE: if the Mimic never takes a measurable sabotage action, they score ZERO — killing passive-troll value. Blunt fire-and-forget flares are CUT (no counterplay). Gated OUT of new-player and Prop Party queues until ~10 matches played. Resolved via the Confessional Vote reveal card. Earned reward: vaulted 'Two-Faced' split-texture morph skin (unbuyable prestige); \$MORPH sells recolors only.
- **Scale Roulette (Official Size Modes)** [5/5/4/5/5 · GAP] — Rotating official player-size modes — Teeny, Normal, Chonk, GIGA — each rebalancing the hide/seek loop, delivering the loudest community wish.
 - Unanimous pick (Big & Little League / Scale Roulette / Handicap Draft merged). Each round rolls or lobby-votes a SERVER-authoritative scale applied to hidere (seekers can also rotate): Teeny 0.4x (2-3x harder to spot, 30-40% slower, can't cover large surfaces, must nest in clutter), Normal, Chonk 1.4x (easy to spot but texture reads at distance so camo skill matters), GIGA 2.2x (very visible, slow, foghorn whistle, but big gaze multiplier as honest compensation). Per-scale scoring rebalance keeps no size strictly best. A 'Mixed Handicap' round (hidere Teeny, seekers GIGA) is the flagship David-and-Goliath party/stream playlist. Ranked = Normal only. Win-rate-based auto-assignment is CUT (invites sandbagging, muddies why you're small) — transparent rolled/voted modifier only. Scale-specific cosmetic lines + hardest-combo 'Mutator Medals'.
- **Tell Skins / Cosmetic Tells (Stealth Rating spine)** [4/4/4/4/5 · GAP] — Every flashy cosmetic carries a published 'Stealth Rating' — the flashiest skins are HARDER to hide in, structurally preventing pay-to-hide.
 - The anti-P2W backbone of the whole economy (Tell Skins + Cosmetic Tells unified). Every purchasable skin has a transparent Stealth Rating shown in shop + scoreboard: plain/earned skins ~100% fidelity (safe, boring); premium 'Molten' leaves a 1px heat-haze, 'Prism' refracts at grazing angles, 'Golden' chimes faintly on the whistle cycle. Spending money makes you EASIER to catch, so the flex is winning DESPITE the tell. The rating feeds the Nerve Engine as an inverse-fidelity score MULTIPLIER (survive a stare in a flashy skin = up to 3x Nerve). A practice-range preview prevents 'cheated by a tell' feeling. This ONE number does triple duty: pricing axis, anti-P2W guarantee, score multiplier. VETO enforced: no cosmetic may reduce splatter-tell duration or any timing/detection stat.
- **Reveal Emotes (Peekaboo economy)** [4/5/4/4/5 · GAP] — Cosmetic emotes invisible while camouflaged that only play when you CHOOSE to break cover — the taunt IS the reveal, and the clip is the product.
 - The anchor cosmetic sink. A perfectly-morphed hider one-taps a Reveal Emote: camouflage drops in a stylized flourish (Sticker-Peel, Melt-and-Reform, Confetti-Burst), a 2s animation + audio sting, then re-morphs. Zero mechanical advantage (risk is identical regardless of skin owned); WHICH animation is pure prestige. 1-per-life cap (no spam/lag). Two-lane sink: high Nerve/Held-Breath streaks unlock 'Signature' tiers that CANNOT be bought — only earned; \$MORPH sells recolors/variants of the earned base. The equipped emote ALSO auto-composites into the Freeze-Frame trophy card when caught — one purchase, two clip

surfaces, guaranteeing even a fast-tagged newbie gets shareable content. Mint-limited rares burn \$MORPH.

- **Freeze-Frame Photobomb (Trophy Card)** [4/5/4/4/5 · GAP] — The instant a hider is tagged, the game snaps a shareable trophy card compositing both players' cosmetics — losers become content.
 - On every tag a ~1.5s cinematic freeze orbits seeker + caught hider and captures a stylized, one-click-shareable trophy card (map, score, both names). Hiders equip a Reveal-Morph that triggers only in the photo (rubber duck, screaming banana); seekers equip a Signature Tag pose (a mint-limited sink too). Rarity watermark ('photobombed by the LEGENDARY Duck') advertises cosmetic rarity on every shared card. Also serves as the fast betrayal-reveal for the Mimic ('MIMIC CONFIRMED'). Curated catalog only (no free-draw) keeps shared images brand-safe. This is the dependency-free shareability win chosen OVER the deferred video reel.
- **First Blob (Onboarding + Practice Range)** [3/2/5/5/5] — A 90-second zero-reading guided first match vs friendly bots that teaches scan/morph/pose-lock/whistle by doing, then hands a free starter cosmetic.
 - The casual advocate's #1 pick — the real game's UI is 'garbage' with no training area. New accounts auto-route to a solo map with 3 dumb seeker bots and big diegetic in-world prompts: 'Walk to a wall → hold to SCAN → release to MORPH → hold to LOCK POSE → a bot is looking, stay still to earn gaze points.' Each step completes by doing it once; no menus. Finishing grants the free non-tradeable 'Rookie Ripple' morph texture (a 'be kind, newbie here' social signal, not a flex) and unlocks matchmaking. A permanent lightweight Practice Range stays in the menu with bots + paint/scale sandbox. Seeds the presets and cosmetics economy from turn one.
- **Rotating Safe Zone** [4/3/4/5/5] — A 12m safe zone shifts every 3 minutes to break camping — the accepted anchor and rhythmic heartbeat of the map.
 - The pre-accepted reference idea, retained as the spine of the dynamic-territory system. A telegraphed 12m sphere where no scoring/tagging happens rotates to a new location every 3 minutes, forcing repositioning. Hosts the Copycat Emote social beat and doubles as a tactical reset. Its dwell-heat philosophy is shared with the sealing/purge systems so anti-camp is coherent map-wide.
- **Pressure System (Tell Debt + Redline Zones + Purge Ring)** [4/4/4/3/4 · GAP] — A three-layer anti-camp stack: personal silhouette-leak, cell sealing, and a high-value flush event — camping is punished coherently at three time scales.
 - Consolidation per Live-Ops upgrade (collapses Tell Debt, Redline Zones, Purge Ring into one philosophy, all dwell-heat-driven). (1) TELL DEBT: staying within a 2m radius fills a hidden meter; at ~90s your true silhouette begins ghosting through your morph (5%→30% opacity), visible only inside a seeker's cone (no wallhack); net-displacement to a NEW coarse grid cell drains it and grants a 4s clean-morph grace (jitter-bots defeated — oscillation stops resetting after 2 bounces). (2) REDLINE ZONES: cells with 40s+ cumulative dwell get a 10s warning then seal, blocking morph-LOCK (not passage); reopen after 60s; cumulative dwell makes the seal-map stale info, not a live tracker. (3) PURGE RING: every 3min a 10m ring spawns on the

hottest dwell cell — survive 12s inside under a genuine seeker's gaze for 3x gaze points, else nameplate force-flickers. Banned/telegraph-locked in ranked to prevent farm arenas.

- **Shape-of-the-Season Silhouette Library** [4/5/4/3/4 · GAP] — Themed body-SHAPE cosmetics (mushroom, crate, gargoyle) sold as mint-limited vaulted seasonal sets — the deepest sink, hanging off the free Fold ability.
 - The paid cosmetic layer of Silhouette Fold (functional ability is a FREE universal unlock; only the shape LIBRARY is sold, cleanly separating power from expression). Each season ships a themed set (S1 'Fungal': mushroom, log, mossy rock; S2 'Junkyard': crate, barrel, traffic cone), all identical hitboxes — purely expressive. Context-gated: a 'traffic cone' shape only reduces detection near real cones and stands out badly elsewhere, so no shape is universally strong (never P2W). Dev-authored (no offensive-content vector). Vaulted after the season = deepest \$MORPH sink. Scale modes multiply value (a GIGA vase vs a Teeny vase are distinct flexes).

Full idea catalog by category

Tiers: **T1** must-build · **T2** strong · **T3** experimental · GAP = fills a gap the original lacks / a player wish.

A — Challenges & Milestones

- **Morph Mastery Trees (dual role challenges)** [T2 · 3/3/5/4/4 · GAP] — Parallel Hider and Seeker challenge trees with cascading daily/weekly/seasonal tiers that fit 9-min rounds and teach the deep mechanics.
 - *How:* Cascading structure: daily (1-2 rounds, 'Survive 30s under gaze'), weekly ('Match 5 different surface materials untagged'), seasonal mastery ('Bank 25k Nerve'). Objectives GATED on the new deep systems ('survive 3 Folds without a tag', 'clutch-reblend x10', 'win a Pulse-read chase') so progression teaches mechanics rather than rewarding rote play. Dual tracks celebrate both roles equally, fixing the hider/seeker engagement asymmetry. Each tier grants Morph Points (soft currency, always an achievable next goal, catch-up allowed, no login-streak punishment). \$MORPH can skip a tier — convenience only, never power. Botting countered by objectives that need real opposition.

B — Cosmetics · Skins · Emotes

- **Tell Skins / Cosmetic Tells (Stealth Rating spine)** [T1 · 4/4/4/4/5 · GAP] — Every flashy cosmetic carries a published 'Stealth Rating' — the flashiest skins are HARDER to hide in, structurally preventing pay-to-hide.
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- **Memory Materials & Palette Vault** [T2 · 3/3/4/4/4] — Save/load morph presets to kill repaint-fatigue, and permanently unlock rare surface materials by surviving rounds morphed onto them — a travel diary of clutch wins.
 - *How:* Two-part sink. (1) Convenience: named save/load morph presets (top community request); slots beyond the first few cost \$MORPH. Enables the one-tap disappear at round start. (2) Prestige: surviving a round morphed onto a specific rare surface (museum marble, a neon sign) permanently unlocks that exact material in your palette; ultra-rares only on limited event maps, mint-limited and tradeable (a \$MORPH-denominated collectible with a secondary market). Never power — any material is matchable live in person by a free player,

so you buy convenience + a record of where you've been. Anti-bot: the survival must include earned gaze/seeker-proximity, not empty-corner AFK.

- **Copycat Emote Duels (no currency)** [T3 · 3/4/3/5/4] — A safe-zone social toy where players mirror emotes together — pure expression, zero currency, so it can't be alt-farmed.
 - *How:* Inside the rotating safe zone (no scoring/tagging), an emote wheel unlocks; players start dances, conga lines, group taunts. VETO ENFORCED: the Morph-Points currency payout is CUT (trivially bottable — park alts, mirror an emote to farm real cosmetic currency). Kept as a PURE social toy with ZERO currency reward, teaching new players that the safe zone is a friendly beat and reinforcing the map's rhythm through play. Emotes are quick animations that don't reveal you outside the safe zone. Newbies get 3 free starter emotes.

C — Sabotage & Social-Deduction

- **The Mimic (Traitor Hider)** [T1 · 5/5/4/3/3 · GAP] — One of the two hiders is secretly the Mimic, scored ONLY by causing their partner's tag — the intimate 2-person knife-in-the-back.
 - *How:* Flagship betrayal role (consolidates Mimic/Impostor Blob/Traitor Chameleon). Spawn rate LOWERED to ~12-15% so most rounds are honestly cooperative and paranoia is earned by rarity. The Mimic sees the partner's faint position pulse; wins only if the OTHER hider is tagged before the timer AND they survive. Sabotage reuses existing systems: the Whistle Roulette THROW aimed AT the ally (ambiguous — taunt or snitch?), plus a gaze-bait beacon. HARD RULE: if the Mimic never takes a measurable sabotage action, they score ZERO — killing passive-troll value. Blunt fire-and-forget flares are CUT (no counterplay). Gated OUT of new-player and Prop Party queues until ~10 matches played. Resolved via the Confessional Vote reveal card. Earned reward: vaulted 'Two-Faced' split-texture morph skin (unbuyable prestige); \$MORPH sells recolors only.
- **Confessional Vote (Post-Round Reveal Card)** [T2 · 4/4/4/4/4 · GAP] — A fast post-round accusation card where survivors finger the suspected traitor — the single legibility layer for ALL hidden-role mechanics.
 - *How:* Reshaped from a 25s meeting phase (vetoed as dead-air/pacing-poison) into a FAST post-round card, per multi-persona consensus. After the round, an anonymized evidence feed (whistle-throw logs, beacon flashes, distress-flare locations, cover-fire arcs) lets players vote who the Mimic/Mole was. Correct majority splits a Detective bonus; a traitor who survives the vote earns a Getaway bonus; correctly voting 'nobody' when no traitor existed rewards skeptics. Never kicks real players (no toxic-removal vector), rewards correct reads not participation (bot-proof). This is the keystone that makes the whole betrayal suite readable and accusable in one place, and prime viewer-participation real estate (chat can vote alongside).
- **The Mole (bribed seeker, hardened)** [T3 · 4/4/3/3/3 · GAP] — One of the 8 seekers is secretly bribed — but scores ONLY on measurable subtle-sabotage, so throwing the whole round nets nothing.
 - *How:* Salvaged from the vetoed Sleeper Seeker by INVERTING the risk (anti-exploit upgrade). One random seeker is the Mole; they earn ONLY from measurable actions (a fake warning-shot ping used to misdirect, a hider surviving a stare the Mole had LOS on) with a HARD per-round cap and ZERO reward for passive non-participation. A single mid-round Interrogate

vote (this idea's signature harness, adopted as the standard for all hidden-seeker roles) lets the team finger the Mole and slash their reward in real time — deterring blatant throwing better than post-round-only reveal. Matchmaking flags repeat Mole-favored-survivor pairs to kill collusion. Currency faucet feeds progression, no cosmetic power. EXPERIMENTAL: seeker-side betrayal risks feel-bad for the 7 honest seekers; ship guarded/limited-playlist first.

- **Splatter Frame Job (Mimic-lobby only)** [T3 · 3/4/3/4/3 · GAP] — In traitor-enabled lobbies, deliberately eat a paint splatter then relocate to leave an innocent teammate glowing — emergent spatial betrayal.
 - *How:* Reserved EXCLUSIVELY for Mimic-enabled lobbies (multi-persona veto of teammate-framing in random solo-queue). A hider can intentionally catch collateral splatter, relocate, and leave a teammate lit to seekers. Counterplay hardening: glow intensity scales with how camouflaged the marked player was (so the FRAMER chooses to sacrifice their own cover), a subtle wet-paint cue shows on the FRAMER's own body for ~1s (the victim/sharp seekers can notice), and a 'wipe' (1.5s wall-rub, morph-locking) cleans it. Smear-transfer capped once per event + 3s post-reblend immunity so one victim can't be chain-griefed. Post-round Confessional Vote provides accountability.
- **Alliance Pact (Shared Fate) — Mimic-gated** [T3 · 3/4/2/3/2 · GAP] — Two hidere forge a compounding-bonus trust pact that either can defect to steal — but only inside Mimic-enabled lobbies, as bait.
 - *How:* Heavily vetoed as a standalone (friend-collusion farm: two premades never defect, split a guaranteed loyalty floor every round). SALVAGED only by gating behind the Mimic system per Social-Deduction upgrade: a Mimic can PROPOSE a Pact purely to lull the true hider into false security, then defect while the partner is under gaze (stealing the pooled bonus + morph-locking them). A visible temptation meter makes the imminent stab legible to spectators. Capped payout + genuine-survival requirement. NOT available in cooperative/non-social lobbies (removes the collusion floor). Feeds divergent 'Loyal Twins' vs 'Backstabber' cosmetic tracks.

D — Dynamic Map / Round Events

- **Rotating Safe Zone** [T1 · 4/3/4/5/5] — A 12m safe zone shifts every 3 minutes to break camping — the accepted anchor and rhythmic heartbeat of the map.
 - *How:* The pre-accepted reference idea, retained as the spine of the dynamic-territory system. A telegraphed 12m sphere where no scoring/tagging happens rotates to a new location every 3 minutes, forcing repositioning. Hosts the Copycat Emote social beat and doubles as a tactical reset. Its dwell-heat philosophy is shared with the sealing/purge systems so anti-camp is coherent map-wide.
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opacity), visible only inside a seeker's cone (no wallhack); net-displacement to a NEW coarse grid cell drains it and grants a 4s clean-morph grace (jitter-bots defeated — oscillation stops resetting after 2 bounces). (2) REDLINE ZONES: cells with 40s+ cumulative dwell get a 10s warning then seal, blocking morph-LOCK (not passage); reopen after 60s; cumulative dwell makes the seal-map stale info, not a live tracker. (3) PURGE RING: every 3min a 10m ring spawns on the hottest dwell cell — survive 12s inside under a genuine seeker's gaze for 3x gaze points, else nameplate force-flickers. Banned/telegraph-locked in ranked to prevent farm arenas.

- **Rift Modifier Wheel (Rotating 3-min Mutators)** [T2 · 4/4/5/4/4 · GAP] — Every 3 minutes the round rolls a public mutator — low gravity, mirror-morph, silent whistles, double gaze — the live-ops variety engine.
 - *How:* A visible HUD wheel spins at each 3-min mark and locks a modifier: Low Gravity (new sightlines, ceiling hides), Mirror Morph (auto-copies your last touched surface — a clip generator tied to the core mechanic), Silent Round (no forced whistles, pure visual hunt), Double Gaze (2x Nerve), Speed Seekers (+50%). Each is a small tuning flag; the wheel UI is the main asset. Server-rolled + public = no info asymmetry to exploit. The SEASONAL delivery vehicle: each Season of Surfaces injects 1-2 new themed mutators and vaults old ones, generating months of variety with reused geometry. Hardest-combo wins mint vaulted 'Mutator Medals.' Harshes mutators disabled in ranked. Casual/party-scoped so balance matters least where comedy matters most.
- **Wet Paint Sweep / Paint Tide** [T2 · 4/4/4/3/4] — A telegraphed paint tide sweeps a strip of the map every ~90s, re-tinting surfaces AND coating hidiers in its path — read it and pre-position, or get exposed.
 - *How:* A telegraphed wall of wet paint (shown 5-8s early as a colored floor line) advances across ~1/4 of the map over ~4s. Surfaces it crosses retint to a new color for ~25s; hidiers caught are force-recolored to that same wet color. Reading the telegraph rewards prediction: sprint INTO the tide to get freshly color-matched to a wall a split-second before a seeker rounds the corner, OR get caught mismatched and forced to re-morph. Seekers learn to walk behind the tide where fresh mismatches glow. Wet-match invincibility bounded to ~6s until paint dries (then Nerve-decay resumes); an audible drip cue near freshly-hit hidiers. Server-randomized color + telegraphed path = un-botched, un-grievable. Cheap: moving decal projector + surface tint uniform + trigger volume.
- **Last Light (End-Game Chaos Phase)** [T2 · 4/5/4/4/5] — In the final 45s the safe zone collapses to a 2m sphere AND a paint front sweeps — one guaranteed climactic, camper-flushing finish every round.
 - *How:* Merges Last Light + Paint Bomb Finale into ONE endgame beat (per Live-Ops upgrade — two mechanics fighting for the same 45s is wasteful). At T-45s: the rotating safe zone collapses to a contested 2m sphere worth a huge survival bonus, surviving hidiers emit a rising pulse glow (camping untenable), seekers gain +30% speed, and a paint front sweeps to color-break memorized spots. Guarantees a decisive finish-line scramble every round, converting slow rounds into highlights. Reuses safe-zone tech + emissive shader + speed flag. Glow is forced/equal (no advantage to buy or bot); surviving Last Light awards 'Clutch' progression toward endgame-themed morphs.

E — Scoring Innovations

- **Nerve Engine (Held Breath + Heat Bloom unified)** [T1 · 5/5/5/3/4 · GAP] — A seeker's stare simultaneously ramps your score multiplier AND drains your morph stability — the stare that pays you is the stare that melts your disguise.
 - *How:* THE keystone merge (Held Breath/Nerve Ladder/Stare-Down + Heat Bloom, endorsed by every persona). While a seeker's active moving cone holds a >75%-matched morphed hider: a private multiplier ramps $x1 \rightarrow x2 \rightarrow x3 \rightarrow x5$ at 3/6/10/15s AND morph stability drains at DOUBLE rate. Points bank per second; any movement >0.3-0.5m or texture change resets the multiplier to $x1$ (banked points are safe) and starts a 2s exhale. At low stability (~20%) a hider-only shimmer warning fires: hold and pray, or risk the 1.2s vulnerable re-lock (full reset on same/good surface, partial on a hasty poor match). Multiplier freezes 4s of grace when the cone leaves. Rendered AS the nameplate turning into a rising NERVE bar (Nameplate Nerve presentation) with a heartbeat SFX; piped to spectator/stream overlay, never to the seeker. 'HELD/Stared Down' banner auto-clips. Anti-farm: seeker must be non-party + actively hunting, per-round Nerve cap, texture-match gate.
- **Nameplate Bounty (go loud)** [T2 · 4/4/3/4/4 · GAP] — Toggling your nameplate ON is a public dare — it doubles your Nerve ceiling and posts a seeker bounty on your head.
 - *How:* Folded INTO the Nerve Engine as an optional amplifier (not a separate system). Default nameplate off. Toggling ON multiplies all your scoring $x2$ and makes you visible to seekers within 20m; a seeker who tags a nameplate-ON hider earns a big bounty (+750). The real game's mismatched-text tell is preserved: a lazy color choice flares the plate brighter, increasing the bounty. 10s toggle lockout prevents flicker-cheesing. Makes nameplate cosmetics (fonts/colors/frames, streamer sigs) load-bearing without power creep. Anti-collusion: cap bounty payouts per pair per session, genuine-LOS tag required.
- **Distress Morph (Dead Man's Tell)** [T2 · 4/4/4/5/5 · GAP] — When a hider is tagged they emit a directional 'last breath' flare heard by all remaining hidere — death becomes information, and a Sole-Survivor bonus rewards nerve.
 - *How:* Merges Last Breath Beacon + Distress Morph. On tag, the eliminated hider flashes a distinctive distress texture + soft audio pulse for ~4s, audible to all living hidere (faintly to seekers), and leaves a 20s paint-stain 'grave' both sides read as compromised. Survivors get reposition info; the round gains audible momentum as the count drops. Surviving 20s after a partner's flare grants a 'Sole Survivor' nerve bonus. A Mimic can deliberately die near the true hider to plant a funneling flare (feeds the Confessional Vote evidence). One flare per genuine tag (unspammable). Flare sound/visual is a cosmetic death-cry SKU.
- **Bounty Hider + Chat's Bounty (position-safe)** [T2 · 4/5/3/3/3 · GAP] — Mid-round the server (or Twitch chat) marks one hider as the Bounty for triple points — but seekers get only a vague heading, never a wallhack.
 - *How:* Merges the server Bounty Hider event with Chat's Bounty. At mid-round one surviving hider is marked; with streamer integration ON, chat's vote SELECTS the target instead of the server rolling. VETO ENFORCED: no through-wall marker and no client-side position reveal (soft-wallhack risk) — seekers get only a vague directional shimmer heading refreshed every ~20s, and only AFTER an honest first sighting. The Bounty hider is told they're marked and earns escalating survival/gaze points, banking a jackpot if they last the window. Anti-repeat

selection prevents perma-hunting one player. Surviving as Bounty progresses a prestige 'Most Wanted' morph line. One event serves both solo retention (server-picked) and viewer virality (chat-picked).

- **Gaze Bank / Nerve Currency** [T2 · 3/4/4/4/4] — Points earned under a seeker's stare become 'Nerve', a non-purchasable soft currency that buys cosmetics — the anti-P2W economic faucet.
 - *How:* Converts accumulated Nerve-Engine points into a soft currency that ONLY buys cosmetics/emotes, never power. Earned Nerve is multiplied by equipped-skin inverse-fidelity (Tell Skins Stealth Rating: plain=1x, flashy=up to 3x), creating the self-balancing loop — the bravest play requires wearing the hardest-to-hide cosmetics. Free players earn cosmetics purely through gutsy play; whales burn \$MORPH for flair. Anti-farm guards bolted on explicitly (per anti-exploit): banks only from a non-party seeker who is actively hunting, per-round cap, >75% morph-match required, pauses if the hider moves >5m or the seeker parks. This is the currency spine the challenge/season economy draws from.
- **Warmth Meter (proximity close-call, LOS-gated)** [T3 · 4/4/3/3/2 · GAP] — A private meter fills while a seeker searches near you without finding you, paying a lump 'Close Call' bonus + escape dash if they leave empty-handed.
 - *How:* Rewards the boldest hiding spots (right under the seeker's nose) rather than distant corners. A private 0-100 meter fills by nearest-seeker distance (fast inside 3m, empties beyond 12m); at 100, if the seeker leaves the bubble without tagging, it cashes a lump 'Close Call' bonus (up to +1000) plus a 2s adrenaline dash to escape. Getting tagged forfeits it. ANTI-EXPLOIT HARDENING (the anti-exploit persona vetoed the raw proximity-only version as the easiest farm on the board): require the seeker to be non-party AND holding genuine LOS/actively hunting (not merely pacing a circle), cap payouts per round, and don't fill if the seeker is parked. Ships only WITH these Held-Breath-grade guards or not at all. Fills faster with better morph match.

F — Modes

- **Scale Roulette (Official Size Modes)** [T1 · 5/5/4/5/5 · GAP] — Rotating official player-size modes — Teeny, Normal, Chonk, GIGA — each rebalancing the hide/seek loop, delivering the loudest community wish.
 - *How:* Unanimous pick (Big & Little League / Scale Roulette / Handicap Draft merged). Each round rolls or lobby-votes a SERVER-authoritative scale applied to hidere (seekers can also rotate): Teeny 0.4x (2-3x harder to spot, 30-40% slower, can't cover large surfaces, must nest in clutter), Normal, Chonk 1.4x (easy to spot but texture reads at distance so camo skill matters), GIGA 2.2x (very visible, slow, foghorn whistle, but big gaze multiplier as honest compensation). Per-scale scoring rebalance keeps no size strictly best. A 'Mixed Handicap' round (hidere Teeny, seekers GIGA) is the flagship David-and-Goliath party/stream playlist. Ranked = Normal only. Win-rate-based auto-assignment is CUT (invites sandbagging, muddies why you're small) — transparent rolled/voted modifier only. Scale-specific cosmetic lines + hardest-combo 'Mutator Medals'.
- **First Blob (Onboarding + Practice Range)** [T1 · 3/2/5/5/5] — A 90-second zero-reading guided first match vs friendly bots that teaches scan/morph/pose-lock/whistle by doing, then hands a free starter cosmetic.

- *How:* The casual advocate's #1 pick — the real game's UI is 'garbage' with no training area. New accounts auto-route to a solo map with 3 dumb seeker bots and big diegetic in-world prompts: 'Walk to a wall → hold to SCAN → release to MORPH → hold to LOCK POSE → a bot is looking, stay still to earn gaze points.' Each step completes by doing it once; no menus. Finishing grants the free non-tradeable 'Rookie Ripple' morph texture (a 'be kind, newbie here' social signal, not a flex) and unlocks matchmaking. A permanent lightweight Practice Range stays in the menu with bots + paint/scale sandbox. Seeds the presets and cosmetics economy from turn one.
- **Prop Party (Chaos Casual Mode)** [T2 · 4/4/4/4/4 · GAP] — A prop-dense, low-stakes 6-hider/4-seeker mode where the environment does the hiding and whistle-taunt comedy runs wild.
 - *How:* A dedicated party playlist on a small prop-dense map (market stall, toy shop) where common surface textures repeat heavily, so a newbie who morphs sloppily still blends into a sea of lookalikes. 5-min rounds, whistles every ~25s (more sound, more taunt windows, more laughs), generous seeker ammo + one Pulse. No ranking — vibes + challenge progress only. A rotating silly modifier each round (everyone bounces, low gravity, pastel morphs). Because everyone blends, players lean on funny/loud cosmetic morphs to stand out — driving safe cosmetic flexing. The Mimic and harsh systems are gated OUT. Hosts the Costume Contest runway between rounds.
- **Mirror Morph (mutator, standalone-worthy)** [T2 · 4/4/3/4/4] — A Rift-Wheel mutator where your morph auto-copies the last surface you touched — a chaotic, core-mechanic-showcasing clip generator.
 - *How:* Called out specifically as a clip generator tied straight to the core mechanic. As a mutator: your morph texture/color continuously auto-copies the last surface you brushed against, so movement paints you — fun chaos where you trail through the environment shifting appearance. Rewards clever routing (touch the wall you want to become) and punishes careless contact. Server-side flag; lives in the Rift Modifier Wheel pool and party playlists. Highlighted separately because it's the wheel's marquee entry and a natural onboarding-friendly 'wow' moment.

G — Social · Streamer · Viewer

- **Costume Contest Intermission** [T2 · 4/4/3/4/4 · GAP] — A 20-second pre-round runway where players show off their morph and everyone (or Twitch chat) votes a winner for a small prize.
 - *How:* Between rounds the lobby becomes a lit runway; each blob auto-poses showing its equipped morph, emote, pet. Everyone taps to vote (can't vote self); top 1-2 get a small Morph Points tip. With streamer integration, Twitch chat casts votes via keyword. The winning morph is spotlighted on the NEXT round's loading screen for the whole lobby — turning a throwaway toy into recurring appointment content and free cosmetic advertising. Celebrates the source game's biggest joy (creative expression, drawing cows/turtles). Anti-abuse: can't self-vote, tiny reward, per-lobby, cosmetic moderation before display, chat votes rate-limited/aggregated.
- **Whistle Skins (audio-swap only)** [T2 · 3/4/3/5/5] — The forced whistle's SOUND becomes a customizable cosmetic — kazoo, opera, air-horn, streamer voice pack — a signature calling card.

- *How:* Pure audio-cosmetic sink tied to the Whistle Roulette mechanic (True/Throw). Swap the whistle SOUND and the decoy-throw VFX; timing/volume fixed so zero balance change. A signature whistle becomes a streamer's recognizable brand identity. VETO ENFORCED: the 'Silence Auction' viewer mute/amplify lever is CUT — letting chat alter a specific non-consenting player's detection odds is pay-to-win-by-proxy and a griefing vector. Keep only the flair swap. Forms a 'Trickster' audio-deception sub-catalog with decoy-pop and thrown-source VFX.

H — Progression & Meta

- **Season of Surfaces (8-week themed seasons)** [T2 · 3/3/5/4/5 · GAP] — Each 8-week season is a themed environment with a re-skinned map, its own morph-tree, an always-on modifier, and a soft-reset rank ladder.
 - *How:* The meta cadence. Each season re-themes the map palette (reuses geometry, swaps textures — cheap: Jungle, Neon City, Stone Ruins) and ships ONE always-on modifier that shifts the meta (Neon: surfaces glow so mismatches punish harder; Jungle: denser cover + longer whistle intervals). Bolts onto the rotating safe zone + Rift Wheel so core pacing visibly changes per season. A soft-reset seasonal rank (Bronze→Morph Master) drives return-at-season-start spikes. The container for all cosmetic sinks: themed morph skins, emotes, paint-trails buyable with play-earned season currency + \$MORPH accelerant. Exclusive vaulted seasonal items create FOMO without loot-box randomness.
- **Prestige Ledger (consolidated earned-cosmetic track)** [T2 · 3/3/4/4/5] — A single collection where every dynamic event contributes a mint-limited seasonal medal — one legible prestige track instead of fragmented one-off auras.
 - *How:* Per Economy upgrade — consolidates all scattered earned auras (Mutator Medals, Purge Survivor, Comeback King, Sole Survivor, Nerves of Steel, Redline-Break) into ONE 'Prestige Ledger' cosmetic collection so the reward space isn't fragmented. Each dynamic event (Purge Ring, Mutator roll, Last Light, Bounty survival) contributes a mint-limited seasonal medal. All earned by play, unbuyable — the anti-P2W status ladder. Denominated so \$MORPH is only a convenience accelerant. Resets softly each season to drive return spikes.

I — Hider / Seeker Abilities

- **Silhouette Fold (Shape Morph)** [T1 · 5/5/5/2/4 · GAP] — Spend a limited charge to collapse your blob's SILHOUETTE into a nearby prop's outline, not just its texture — become the furniture.
 - *How:* Consolidation of Silhouette Break + Fold + Shape-of-the-Season. Aim at a small/medium prop within 4m, hold 1.2s to fold: your outer mesh approximates that prop's outline and snaps texture to match. While folded you are near-undetectable but movement-LOCKED, hold up to 20s, 2 charges/round (regen 1 per 3min, cap 2). Fold quality degrades with volume mismatch (a huge prop = loose fold, a tell). Fold snaps to a validated surface anchor BESIDE geometry (never inside — kills no-clip). Unfold takes 1s with an audible pop that auto-flags the highlight system. Morph stability (Heat Bloom) still drains while folded, forcing eventual unfold. Returns NO Pulse ping for a few seconds. The FUNCTIONAL ability is a free universal progression unlock; the shape LIBRARY (vase vs box vs gargoyle, identical hitboxes, context-gated) is the paid seasonal cosmetic layer.

- **Whistle Roulette (choose your tell)** [T1 · 5/5/4/4/4 · GAP] — The forced ~45s whistle becomes a bluff economy: emit True for a nerve bonus, Throw a decoy, or Mute at a cost — but you can never go fully silent.
 - *How:* Definitive consolidation of all whistle proposals (Tell / Whistle Roulette / Whistle Cipher / Silence Auction mechanics). Holding still fills a Silence-credit meter that gates spends. 5s before each forced whistle a radial prompt offers: TRUE (emits from real position, +honest-nerve points scaled by nearest-seeker proximity — a point-blank taunt is max risk/reward), or THROW (decoy sound from an LOS-validated point up to 10-20m away, costs the full meter, has a traceable 3s wind-up hiss audible within 8m, hard cooldown, ~2/round). A MUTE option is CUT per anti-exploit consensus — silent camping stays impossible; ignoring the prompt defaults to TRUE. Serial whistlers get progressively pinned by a seeker audio-triangulation passive that sharpens per whistle. Whistle SOUND, throw VFX are cosmetic SKUs (kazoo, opera, streamer voice packs) — timing/volume fixed, never P2W. The Mimic reuses THROW aimed AT the ally as its snitch tool (no bespoke mechanic).
- **Pulse Ping (readable seeker scan)** [T1 · 4/4/4/4/5 · GAP] — Seekers get a telegraphed sonar pulse that flags morph MISMATCH — but well-blended hidere are invisible to it and spam self-punishes.
 - *How:* Press to emit a 12m LOS-gated ring over ~1.5s with a loud charge-up SFX + visible shockwave (giving hidere ~1s to freeze/reblend). Any hider inside whose texture-match is below ~70% gets a 2s highlight; perfectly-blended and Folded hidere return nothing. Cooldown 45s, and each pulse revealing nobody adds +15s to the next cooldown (anti-spam). Freshly-splattered or mid-re-lock hidere ping BRIGHTER; Folded hidere ping not at all — hard-wiring the Fold/Pulse/Warning-Shot counterplay triangle. Never sees through walls. Pulse VFX/SFX are seeker cosmetic sinks.
- **Marked / Splatter Chain (collateral only)** [T2 · 4/4/3/4/4] — A seeker's shot splatters paint that marks nearby hidere with a glowing wet stain they must scrub off — turning wild shots into scored area denial.
 - *How:* Builds on canon collateral splatter. A hit OR miss throws paint in an ~8m radius; caught hidere get a wet-paint stain that mismatches their morph and glows to seekers for ~6s. A 'clutch reblend' (re-scan within 2s) clears it for a +bonus. AMMO ECONOMY is the anti-spray governor: a miss burns extra ammo, a splatter that tags a hidden hider refunds partial — blanket-spraying self-punishes. Marks fade if unscrubbed-and-unseen for ~15s. Scrubbing reuses the morph loop as a risk window. VETO enforced: intentional teammate smear-transfer-to-frame is CUT in all non-social modes (grief bait) and reserved ONLY for Mimic-enabled lobbies with post-round accountability. Stain color/pattern is cosmetic; timing is never purchasable.
- **Warning Shot Economy** [T2 · 4/4/3/4/4 · GAP] — Seekers fire a cheap non-lethal warning shot that flinches everything nearby — real hidere twitch, decoys and props don't.
 - *How:* A warning shot costs half-ammo and hits ~5m. Every real hider caught involuntarily micro-flinches (a 0.3s silhouette wobble) unless they spend a 'steel nerve' hold — holding perfectly still banks +unflinching points. Decoys, Folded silhouettes, and true props do NOT flinch, so the shot is an information probe: whatever twitches is alive. A warning shot that lands zero flinches refunds partial ammo (mirrors the splatter refund), making a correct probe economically neutral and a wrong one costly. Half-ammo cost + limited total ammo self-

punish spam. Muzzle VFX are seeker cosmetic sinks; flinch is universal, mitigation is pure skill.

- **Decoy Shed (bait gadget)** [T2 · 4/5/3/4/4 · GAP] — Drop a frozen morph-clone of yourself as bait, slip away, and make a seeker waste a precious shot on the fake.
 - *How:* Unified from four decoy proposals: 1 charge/round, static morph-snapshot of your current pose/texture, non-solid (can't clog or griefer-block), 25s lifetime. Whistles once on its own timer to mask your real whistle; pops into paint splatter if shot, wasting the seeker's precious ammo and paying you +baited points (CAPPED per round so a colluding seeker can't feed decoy-kills). Skill counterplay tell: decoys never breathe/micro-idle, and they ping faintly under Pulse — patient seekers can distinguish them. Inherits your equipped morph skin (flashy skins = convincing bait, cosmetic value, zero power). Pop VFX and 'baited' taunt emotes are sinks. A wasted LAST shot on a decoy triggers a special GOTCHA trophy card.
- **Second-Chance Ghost / Do-Over Dome (casual-only, non-scoring)** [T3 · 3/3/4/3/3] — In casual, tagged hidere become non-scoring ghosts who can dash to a telegraphed Do-Over Dome for ONE respawn — comeback drama without diluting eliminations.
 - *How:* Merges Second-Chance Ghost + Do-Over Domes, restricted per multiple vetoes. Tagged hidere become translucent, non-scoring ghosts (keeps them engaged — dead-time is the #1 new-player retention killer). Instead of a passive trickle, the ghost's goal is reaching a telegraphed Do-Over Dome that fades in once mid-round for a single respawn as an unmorphed blob at a random exposed edge. CONSTRAINED: casual/party queues ONLY (classic full-elimination in ranked, protecting the finality the Distress Morph / Last Light beats depend on); the ghost 'Boo' fake-whistle is CUT (vetoed — muddies the load-bearing seeker audio-read with no counterplay). One re-entry per hider; dome telegraphed so seekers can ambush.

Community-grounded additions (from real player sentiment)

Scores /10.

- **Lighting-Aware Fold** [tier-1-must-build · 9/8/9/4/8 · Sabotage & Social-Deduction] — The silhouette fold auto-borrows its target prop's local shading and reflection profile so a folded hider is lit exactly like the object it became.
 - *How:* On fold, the morphed mesh samples the surrounding light probes / reflection profile of the mimicked prop and matches specular, albedo and ambient occlusion server-deterministically. Removes the spurious-reflection tell at the moment of disguise.
 - *Players said:* Directly answers the #1 verbatim complaint — 'lighting/reflections make players look nothing like the surroundings', things 'reflect light for some odd reason.' Makes the marquee mechanic robust to the exact rendering bug that plagues Meccha.
- **Disguise Read Meter (pre-commit)** [tier-1-must-build · 8/6/9/7/7 · Sabotage & Social-Deduction] — A private in-round gauge showing how well your CURRENT morph reads under the room's actual lighting and the nearest seeker's angle.
 - *How:* Client-side 0-100% camo score computed from color-match, silhouette-edge break, and current lighting exposure vs the surface you're mimicking; updates as you move/repaint.

Learnable, skill-expressing, never shown to seekers.

- *Players said:* Turns 'the lighting betrayed me and I couldn't tell' into learnable information; players already crave the answer-check feedback loop but want it BEFORE they die, not only after.
- **Server-Authoritative Line-of-Sight Streaming ('Fog of Data')** [tier-1-must-build · 6/5/9/3/10 · netcode / anti-cheat] — A hider only exists on a seeker's client once the server confirms them in view — so devtools/ESP overlays have nothing to read.
 - *How:* No render-then-hide. Server culls hider position/mesh/texture from the seeker's payload until legitimate LOS+range. Turns anti-ESP from a bolt-on into a core netcode property.
 - *Players said:* 'Seeker wallhack' and 'position spoofing' are named top cheat vectors; public lobbies already have 'invincibility cheaters.' On a Three.js stack the only real defense is not sending the data.
- **Answer-Check Replay + One-Tap Clip Card** [tier-1-must-build · 8/10/8/6/8 · virality / results] — Auto-generated 6-10s watermarked vertical highlight of your best morph (or funniest bust) at round end, one tap to TikTok/Shorts.
 - *How:* The results screen records the round's best silhouette morph and the 'how did I miss THAT' reveal angle, renders a vertical clip with watermark, exports in one tap. Every player becomes a distribution node without a separate emote system.
 - *Players said:* The reveal is the most-clipped moment in the genre; the catalog stops at an emote and never packages it for distribution. Bakes the clip factory into the loop players already love.
- **Rematch-With-Party button** [tier-1-must-build · 7/6/10/8/9 · retention / social plumbing] — One tap on the results screen keeps your whole party together in the next lobby.
 - *How:* Persists the party group into the next matchmade lobby at the exact moment players decide to stay or leave; complements invite links and party persistence.
 - *Players said:* Party-join friction is the #1 churn driver; the 'round ended, now what?' gap is where friend groups fracture. Directly attacks D7 return.
- **Skill-Gated Morph Lock (anti auto-paint)** [tier-2-strong · 7/5/7/6/9 · Sabotage & Social-Deduction] — Matching a surface requires holding still through a brief server-timed focus bar — humans manage it, bots get timing-flagged.
 - *How:* The 'match nearest surface' action resolves server-side over a short focus window rather than instantly; inhuman timing/pixel-perfect locks are rate-limited and flagged. Improves feel AND kills auto-paint.
 - *Players said:* Meccha's eyedropper+HSV morph is trivially scriptable; on a browser it's a JS call a bot can spam, making hidere unbeatable. Keeps a human skill gate on the core verb.
- **Seeker 'Second Look' read tool** [tier-2-strong · 8/7/7/7/8 · seeker balance] — A cooldown-gated close-inspect that rewards a correct hider read with a small bonus and punishes a wrong accusation.

- *How:* Server-authoritative focused inspect on a suspected prop; correct = catch + small reward, wrong = cooldown penalty. Answers the 'seeker toolkit narrowed' complaint without giving a wallhack.
- *Players said:* Seekers feel their toolkit is 'broken'/'narrowed'; this rewards reads rather than replacing them, the correct fix for the asymmetry complaint.
- **Seeker Escalation Clock (replaces Whistle Roulette)** [tier-2-strong · 7/7/8/7/8 · pacing / anti-stall] — Pulse Ping auto-intensifies and heat rises toward stale hiders as the 9-min timer drains — fair rising pressure, not RNG death.
 - *How:* Server-driven, telegraphed escalation: scan radius/frequency and last-hider heat increase over time; a hard end-of-round reveal guarantees no unfindable stalemate. Replaces forced-random whistle.
 - *Players said:* Players rage at randomness that causes death 'through no fault of mine' (already primed by lighting/eyedropper betrayals); the perennial 'last hider is impossible to find' seeker pain needs a fair fix.
- **Deaf-Safe Visual Whistle** [tier-2-strong · 6/6/7/7/8 · Challenges & Milestones] — The forced-tell becomes a server-driven on-screen shockwave + controller haptic, audio optional.
 - *How:* Every involuntary tell emits a screen-edge ripple / directional caption and haptic, server-authoritative so it can't be client-muted or spoofed. One redesign serves colorblind/deaf/muted-tab players AND removes a spoofable client audio cue.
 - *Players said:* Audio-gated reveals lock out deaf/HoH and muted browser-tab players (a real accessibility gap); client-side audio is spoofable/muteable by cheaters.
- **Tell Legend on death** [tier-2-strong · 8/7/8/7/8 · Modes] — The results screen replays the EXACT tell that got you found — silhouette edge, whistle, motion — so death is learnable, not mysterious.
 - *How:* Records and highlights the specific signal the seeker read; codifies a learnable 'tell grammar.' Players accept death when the tell was learnable and quit when reveals feel arbitrary.
 - *Players said:* Fairness perception depends on legibility; the beloved answer-check exists precisely because players want to learn 'why the disguise failed.'
- **Camo Preset Loadouts (freemium honest hook)** [tier-2-strong · 7/5/8/8/9 · Scoring Innovations] — Save, name, share and hot-swap favorite texture+silhouette combos; a few slots free, more for a flat USD price.
 - *How:* Named preset slots equipped per map surface at round start. Sells convenience, never power — the one purchase players actually ask for, resolving the 'selling expression in a blend-in game' irony.
 - *Players said:* Players of the paint genre beg to save favorite morphs so they don't rebuild every round; preset-saving is the cleanest non-P2W, non-gacha first purchase.
- **Radically Honest Shop (USD-priced, guaranteed, no gacha)** [tier-2-strong · 5/6/7/8/9 · Scoring Innovations] — Every cosmetic shows a real-dollar price, 100% guaranteed (no loot boxes), with a spend counter, optional limit and a refund window.

- *How:* Stripe/USD cosmetics, no randomness, session spend visibility, refund on accidental buys. The only structure that lets an ex-no-MTX audience tolerate a shop; auditable by a skeptical streamer in one screenshot.
- *Players said:* Audience comes from a beloved zero-MTX game and distrusts any shop; loot-box/gacha would be brand suicide and PEGI/FTC-flagged. Transparency is the trust moat.
- **Daily/Weekly Contract system + Featured Modifier rotation** [tier-2-strong · 7/6/9/8/7 · live-ops / retention] — Rotating morph challenges ('hide as a chair on 3 maps', 'survive final 30s x3') plus weekly rule twists (no-scan week, giant-morph week) — variety without new maps.
 - *How:* Server-issued rotating objectives feeding the battle-pass/XP, plus a weekly featured modifier reusing existing maps. Cheapest anti-repetitiveness lever for a solo dev.
 - *Players said:* The genre churns at hour 1 from repetitiveness ('seen everything'), not from lack of a coin sink; content cadence via rules/objectives beats an asset treadmill.
- **Earned Battle-Pass + Ranked ladder** [tier-2-strong · 7/6/9/5/8 · live-ops / progression] — Free + premium seasonal track with earnable morphs/paints and an MMR ranked queue with seasonal soft-reset.
 - *How:* Daily/weekly reason to return plus a reason to climb; cosmetics earnable via mastery of color-matching and folds so progression rewards the core loop instead of bypassing it.
 - *Players said:* Repetitiveness-after-1-hour is cured by a reason to climb; cosmetic sinks do not retain, a ladder and earned track do. Skill-gated earning also de-risks the P2E-repulsion flagged.
- **Spectate-to-Clip / Ghost Director for eliminated players** [tier-2-strong · 7/8/8/6/8 · virality / retention] — Caught hiders get a free-cam to keep watching, cheering and one-tap clipping the best hides.
 - *How:* Eliminated players spectate live, ping clip timestamps, and export — turning dead-time into more clip capture (Among Us kept the dead as ghosts). Cuts the 'found in 30s, bored for 8 minutes' churn.
 - *Players said:* Dead-player dead-time is a stream-killer and a churn event; spectating turns waiting into engagement and crowdsources the highlight reel.
- **Bot-backfill for thin lobbies** [tier-2-strong · 6/5/8/6/7 · matchmaking / retention] — Fill 10-player rooms with morph bots so friends never wait and seekers always have targets; ramp bots down as humans join.
 - *How:* Server spins up capped morph bots below a player threshold, replaced by humans on join. Keeps a small off-peak game playable and a party of 3 starting instantly.
 - *Players said:* Thin matchmaking and lobby-timeout spirals are named top churn killers for a sub-1K-CCU browser launch; an empty lobby is instant churn.
- **Stream-Snipe Honeypot + Streamer Mode** [tier-2-strong · 8/9/6/6/7 · virality / streamer] — Streamer Mode masks the join code and seat; an optional decoy morph the host plants makes snipers commit to the wrong prop — turning a threat into a clip.

- *How:* Hide/delay join code, anonymize/randomize the streamer's seat, lobby-entry delay, plus a planted decoy morph. Hide-and-seek is uniquely snipe-vulnerable (viewers see where you hid).
- *Players said:* Without snipe protection streamers stop playing on-stream, killing the acquisition channel; the honeypot converts the sniping threat into shareable content.
- **Collusion Dampener** [tier-3-experimental · 4/4/6/6/9 · Challenges & Milestones] — Cap rewards/round from any single lobby and flag repeat same-account pairings, neutering stare-farming and Mimic-buddy exploits.
 - *How:* Per-lobby reward ceiling + detection of recurring account pairings; matches suspicious pairs apart. Removes the incentive to farm any gameplay-signal reward with two accounts.
 - *Players said:* Any 'get paid for X in-round' mechanic is farmable by colluding accounts (the Axie/StepN failure mode); this is the guardrail if any earn faucet survives.
- **Community Palette / Silhouette Packs (creator revenue-share)** [tier-3-experimental · 6/6/7/4/6 · Scoring Innovations] — Player-made texture and silhouette packs sold at honest USD prices with a creator split — the economy as artist support, not speculation.
 - *How:* Curated UGC packs, creator paid in USDC/SOL (token only as optional bonus). Fits the art-game ethos far better than a speculative coin and turns a solo dev's content ceiling into an infinite tail.
 - *Players said:* Meccha thrives on Steam Workshop UGC; making the economy about supporting artists resolves the 'selling expression' dissonance and adds map/asset cadence.
- **Lobby Best-Disguise viewer vote** [tier-3-experimental · 7/8/6/7/7 · virality / engagement] — A 10-second post-round poll where the audience (and lobby) picks the funniest hide.
 - *How:* Quick reveal-moment vote surfaced on the results screen; winner gets an earned (never bought) status badge and the clip gets flagged for the highlight reel.
 - *Players said:* Free engagement plus crowd-sourced clip selection; the reveal is the beloved social beat and voting extends it without toxic free-text.

What real players validated vs contradicted

- **SILHOUETTE FOLD** — **VALIDATED:** unanimous across all lenses as the ONE justified differentiator and the credible reason to leave a 10M-copy incumbent; Meccha's hide toolkit is called 'broken' yet is still only texture+pose on a fixed body. But gated on lighting fairness and no-clip honesty to feel fair.
- **TELL SKINS** (flashy = harder to hide) — **VALIDATED:** the strongest anti-P2W idea; directly answers the loudest monetization fear and converts the lighting/reflection bug into an intentional, fair risk/reward axis. Should govern the ENTIRE cosmetics catalog, not be one item.
- **ROTATING SAFE ZONE + PRESSURE SYSTEM** (anti-camp) — **VALIDATED:** camping ('people hiding in corners') is a named live degradation; anti-camp pressure and stalemate-flushing are table-stakes pacing, not novelty.

- PULSE PING (seeker scan) — VALIDATED (conditional): answers a real seeker-asymmetry complaint AND kills demand for third-party ESP — but ONLY if server-authoritative over what's revealed. A client-trusted ping is itself the wallhack.
- Post-round REVEAL / expanded 'answer check' — VALIDATED: 'the fastest feedback loop in the game for learning what actually works.' Should be elevated from a scoreboard to a flagship retention + clip-factory system.
- NERVE ENGINE (stare melts disguise + pays you) — CONTRADICTED as specified: the tension half is validated (players love the terror of being stared at; makes answer-check feedback continuous), but the PAYOUT half is a bot-farmable faucet and inverts the loop by rewarding being spotted. Keep the pressure, kill the money.
- THE MIMIC (traitor hider) — CONTRADICTED: no evidence of demand; imports Among Us's social-deduction lane and a grieving/collusion surface into lobbies that ALREADY suffer griefers/cheaters a solo dev can't yet police. Wrong problem, wrong time — at most a post-safety opt-in casual mode.
- WHISTLE ROULETTE — CONTRADICTED: RNG that causes death 'through no fault of mine' compounds the core unfairness grievance and is audio-gated (accessibility miss + client-spoofable). Redesign as the telegraphed, skill-mitigable Seeker Escalation Clock + Visual Whistle.
- SCALE ROULETTE (official size modes) — NEUTRAL / conditionally validated: size clips are a real viral surface, but it fragments a fragile matchmaking pool and amplifies no-clip/hitbox exploits if shipped before anti-cheat. Quarantine to a casual/rotating playlist, not the marquee set.
- REVEAL EMOTES — NEUTRAL: the taunt-on-reveal beat is a beloved genre staple worth keeping as low-cost flavor, but it is orthogonal to the 'art defeated by tech' pain and must NOT be a headline system while the eyedropper mis-picks colors. Fold clip value into the Clip Card instead.
- Self-issued \$MORPH coin + deep sink economy — CONTRADICTED: zero verified demand, UNVERIFIED appetite, and active warning signals (98.6% rug rate, crypto-averse clip audience, P2E-repulsion). The reference game proved the loop sells with NO economy.

Cut / redesigned (don't build these as-is)

- \$MORPH coin as a launch pillar — CUT from v1. Appetite is UNVERIFIED and the reference game hit ~\$9.9M at flat \$5.99 with zero MTX; a pump.fun token reads as a rug (98.6% rug rate), invites SEC/FTC scrutiny, gets streamers review-bombed as shills, and poisons the exact organic-virality engine the game needs. Reversible experiment only, post-PMF.
- NERVE ENGINE payout — CUT the economic coupling. Reward flowing from a gameplay signal is farmable by two colluding accounts and P2E-adjacent; it also inverts the core fantasy (rewards being spotted, punishes good hiding). Keep the 'being watched melts your disguise' tension as pure pressure with zero currency; money and gameplay signals must never touch.
- THE MIMIC — DEPRIORITIZE to post-safety opt-in casual mode. No demand signal, wrong genre lane, and a grieving/collusion amplifier (Mimic + friend seeker = guaranteed wins/harassment) in lobbies with no moderation floor yet.
- WHISTLE ROULETTE — REDESIGN, don't ship as-is. Pure RNG that causes death compounds the fairness grievance and is audio-gated. Replace with the telegraphed Seeker Escalation Clock and a server-driven Visual Whistle.

- **SCALE ROULETTE** — DEPRIORITIZE to a casual/rotating playlist post-anti-cheat. Fun clip fuel but fragments thin matchmaking and amplifies hitbox/no-clip exploits; belongs in casual, never ranked, and never in the marquee launch set.
- **REVEAL EMOTES** as a headline system — DEPRIORITIZE to low-cost flavor. Cute but orthogonal to the real pain; do not over-index on expression while the core tools are broken. Roll its clip value into the auto Clip Card.
- 'Deep sink-anchored cosmetics economy' as a flagship — DEPRIORITIZE. Retention in this genre is driven by map/rules cadence + progression, not sinks; an economy built on a loop that doesn't retain yet is theme-park-before-parking-lot. It is a post-retention layer.
- Fixed single 9-min round shape as the only structure — DEPRIORITIZE. One length can't serve both the viral-clip and ranked-ladder audiences; split into casual (long/chaotic) vs ranked (tighter, anti-camp-tuned).

Must-fix table-stakes (before novelty matters)

- **[P0-existential] Frictionless friend/party join + invite link + rejoin + party persistence** — One-click invite URL/short code, join-friend-in-progress, party stays together across rounds and auto-fills the next lobby, reconnect-after-drop into your same hider/seeker state, browser-native no-download/no-wallet gate.
- **[P0-existential] Server-authoritative visibility + anti-cheat (no-clip, ESP/wallhack, position spoof, auto-paint)** — Never transmit a hider's position/mesh to a seeker client until server-confirmed in line-of-sight ('fog of data'); server-validate collision/movement/speed to block no-clip and wall-hiding; detect auto-paint/eyedropper bots via timing; honeypot props to catch ESP.
- **[P0-existential] Lighting/reflection fairness pass for camouflage (core-loop integrity)** — Deterministic hider-fair shading: suppress spurious specular/reflection on morphed surfaces, match hider albedo+lighting to the surface mimicked, and give a client preview of how the disguise reads under current lighting.
- **[P0-existential] Moderation + child-safety layer (report/mute/block/vote-kick, chat filter, minor-safe defaults)** — In-round report, per-player mute/block, lobby vote-kick, profanity/name filter, voice defaulted off/push-to-talk, no open DMs to minors, AFK auto-remove, lightweight ban pipeline a solo dev can run.
- **[P1-critical] Paint/morph tool QoL: accurate eyedropper + presets + averaging + undo** — Fix eyedropper so sampled hue equals applied hue; add averaging (multi-textel) sample, hex/RGB input, HSV sliders, recently-used + save/load/named palettes, fill bucket, undo/redo, snap-to-prop, one-key re-apply last morph, pre-round practice.
- **[P1-critical] Seeker-side balance kit + anti-stall + seeker progression** — Server-authoritative scan (PULSE PING), escalating hint/heat toward stale hidere as the clock drains, last-hider pity heat, hard round-end reveal, seeker XP/rewards, telemetry-driven win-rate balancing, seeker count scaled to lobby/map.
- **[P1-critical] Accessibility suite (colorblind, visual cues for audio tells, remap, reduced motion/scale)** — Deuteranopia/protanopia/tritanopia palettes and colorblind-safe seeker outlines +

answer-check markers, a visual/haptic equivalent for every audio tell (whistle/footsteps/ping), full key remap, one-hand/controller support, reduced-motion and scale-comfort options.

- **[P1-critical] Expanded end-of-round 'answer check' / results screen + clip export** — Build on the loved reveal: per-hider reveal + gaze heatmap, disguise-quality score (color-match %, silhouette read, lighting exposure), 'why you were caught' tell replay, MVP/best-hide/funniest-fail, XP/challenge progress, keep-party rematch button, and one-tap vertical clip export to TikTok/Shorts.
- **[P2-important] Reliable netcode + thin-lobby matchmaking (backfill/bot-fill, region, reconnect)** — Sub-150ms WebSocket sync, mid-round backfill and optional bot-fill so a 10-lobby dropping to 4 stays playable, region matching, host-migration, lobby-timeout recovery.
- **[P2-important] Onboarding: 60-second first round + practice sandbox + ranked/casual split** — Guided/bot-populated first match teaching morph+fold, a solo practice prop room, never dumping a new player into a sweaty human lobby as a lost seeker, and separate casual (chaos/novelty/friends) vs ranked (tight, integrity-enforced, no size-abuse) queues with basic MMR.

Build order

1. PHASE 0 — EXISTENTIAL FLOOR (blocks launch, ships before ANY novelty): (1) Frictionless friend/party join + invite link + rejoin + rematch-with-party; (2) Server-authoritative visibility 'fog of data' + no-clip/anti-cheat + skill-gated morph lock; (3) Lighting/reflection fairness pass; (4) Moderation + child-safety layer with minor-safe defaults. These four are the platform; nothing else matters if they're broken.
2. PHASE 1 — CORE-LOOP INTEGRITY + THE ONE FLAGSHIP: Lighting-Aware Silhouette Fold (over-invested, the whole differentiator), Disguise Read Meter, paint/eyedropper QoL + Camo Preset Loadouts, and the expanded 'answer check' results screen with Tell Legend + one-tap Clip Card. This is where morph finally becomes the dominant skill and the clip engine turns on.
3. PHASE 1 (parallel) — SEEKER FAIRNESS + ACCESS: server-authoritative Pulse Ping + Seeker Escalation Clock + Second Look + seeker progression; Rotating Safe Zone/Pressure; full accessibility suite (colorblind, Visual Whistle, remap, reduced motion); netcode + bot-backfill for thin lobbies; casual/ranked split + 60-second onboarding + practice sandbox.
4. PHASE 2 — RETENTION SCAFFOLD (once the loop retains): earned Battle-Pass + Ranked ladder, Daily/Weekly Contracts + Featured Modifier rotation, Spectate-to-Clip / Ghost Director, Streamer Mode + Snipe Honeytrap, map/UGC pipeline. Content cadence via rules and objectives, cheap for a solo dev.
5. PHASE 3 — HONEST MONETIZATION TEST (only after a healthy population proves demand): Radically Honest USD Shop selling convenience (preset slots) and hiding-neutral or TELL-penalized cosmetics; Community Palette Packs with creator revenue-share. TELL-skins principle governs every item; auditable in one screenshot.
6. PHASE 4 — REVERSIBLE EXPERIMENTS (optional, post-PMF, ring-fenced): \$MORPH coin as a cosmetics-only sink that NEVER touches gameplay signals, guarded by the Collusion Dampener; THE MIMIC and Scale Roulette as opt-in casual/chaos modes; viewer Best-Disguise vote. Ship fun without any of these; treat each as a removable test with a kill switch.

7. SEQUENCING RULE: table-stakes RETAIN, novelty DIFFERENTIATES — you cannot monetize a population that churns over friction, cheating, or feeling unsafe. Every decision is judged against: 'can two 11-year-old friends get into one lobby, understand it in a minute, feel safe, play fair, and want a rematch?'